TRINH PHAM

KDI School of Public Policy and Management
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Last updated: October 2026

EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor, KDI School of Public Policy and Management, August 2024 – present

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Applied Economics and Management, Cornell University, May 2024
Dissertation Title: "Essays in Development and Environmental Economics"
Dissertation Committee: Christopher B. Barrett, John F. Hoddinott, Ariel Ortiz-Bobea

M.P.P. Regional Development and Environment, KDI School of Public Policy and Management, 2017
Summa Cum Laude, Salutatorian; *Minor in Sustainable Development*

B.Ec. International Economic Relations, Vietnam National University Ho Chi Minh City, 2015
Honours with Distinction

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS *(including articles accepted for publication and forthcoming publications)*

5. "The Environmental Cost of Place-Based Industrial Policy: Evidence from Industrial Zones in Vietnam." (2026). *Accepted, Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*

4. "Mentoring, Educational Preferences, and Career Choices: Evidence from Two Field Experiments in Bhutan." (2025). *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, with Ryotaro Hayashi, Hyuncheol Bryant Kim and Norihiko Matsuda.

3. "Structural Transformation, Agriculture, Climate, and the Environment." (2023). *Review of Environmental Economics and Policy*, Vol 17, No 2, with Christopher B. Barrett and Ariel Ortiz-Bobea.

2. "The Child Education and Health Ethnic Inequality Consequences of Climate Shocks in Vietnam." (2022). *Economics of Education Review*, Vol 90, 102311.

1. "The Intertemporal Evolution of Agriculture and Labor over a Rapid Structural Transformation: Lessons from Vietnam." (2020). *Food Policy*, Vol 94, 101913, with Yanyan Liu, Christopher B. Barrett, and William Violette.

WORKING PAPERS

1. "Temperature Shocks, Worker Age, and Sectoral Reallocation into Informality: Evidence from Vietnam" *(Revision Requested, Journal of Development Economics)*
   A previous version was circulated as "Climate Change and Intersectoral Labor Reallocation in a Developing Country" – Distinguished PhD Research Paper Award by the Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics (NEUDC 2023, Harvard Kennedy School)

2. "Who Benefits from Place-Based Industrial Policies? Labor Market Adjustments and Household Welfare in Vietnam" *(Revision Requested, Journal of Public Economics)*

3. "Place-based Industrial Policies and Intergenerational Educational Inequality: Evidence from Vietnam"

SELECTED WORK-IN-PROGRESS

1. "The Psychological Cost of High-Stakes Exams: Evidence from South Korea," with Jinseong Park
2. "Motivational Framing and Work-Place Conflicts: Experimental Evidence from Vietnamese Industrial Parks," with Changkeun Lee and David Sungho Park

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

† denotes Master's level courses, * denotes PhD-level courses

KDI School, Instructor

† Environmental Economics in Developing Countries, Spring 2025–2026

† Introduction to Development Policy, Spring 2025–2026, Fall 2025

* Development Economics, Fall 2024–2025

Cornell University, Teaching Assistant (unless stated otherwise)

† Applied Econometrics, Professor Brian Dillon, Fall 2021/2023

Math and Statistics camp for incoming Master's students (Co-instructor), Summer 2022

Economics of Developing Countries, Professor Brian Dillon, Spring 2021–2022

† Research and Methods, Professors Mark Constas and Aija Leiponen, Fall 2020

† Risk Simulation and Monte Carlo Methods, Professor Calum Turvey, Spring 2020

Introduction to Economics of Development, Professor Steven Kyle, Fall 2019

HONORS, AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Food Policy, *Outstanding Reviewer Award 2025*

Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA), *Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation Award 2025*

Cornell Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management, *Best PhD Dissertation Award 2025*

JPAL Learning for All Initiative, *Proposal Development Grant*, with Maulik Jagnani

KDI School, *Research Grant*

The Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, *Weiss Family Distinguished PhD Research Paper Award at NEUDC 2023, Harvard Kennedy School*

Cornell Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management, *George F. Warren Award First Place 2024*

Cornell University, *Graduate School Fellowship Spring 2024, Conference Travel Grant 2021-2023*

KDI School, *Outstanding Thesis & Academic Excellence 2016, Global Ambassador Scholarship 2015-2016*

Vietnam National University Ho Chi Minh City, *Student of Five Merits 2014*, University of Economics and Law *Dean's List 2011-2015*

Rencontres du Vietnam *Odon Vallet Scholarship 2015*, POSCO *Asia Fellowship 2014*, American Chamber of Commerce in Ho Chi Minh City *Scholarship 2014*

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Conference, Workshop, and Seminar Presentations (*including scheduled*, * presented by co-authors)

2026: Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society, KDI School - World Bank Development Impact Conference, Sungkyunkwan University, Northeastern Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC, Cornell University), Asian & Australasian Society of Labour Economics Conference (AASLE)*

2025: Korea Institute for International Economic Policy, Asian Economic Development Conference*, National Cheng Kung University, KDI School - World Bank Development Impact Conference, Northeastern Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC, Tufts University)

2024: University of Melbourne, Taipei School of Economics and Political Science, KDI School - World Bank Development Impact Conference, Asian & Australasian Society of Labour Economics Conference (AASLE)

2023: Midwest International Economic Development Conference, Climate Economics Pipeline Workshop (Harvard Kennedy School), Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), LSE Environment Week (London School of Economics), Development Workshop (Cornell University), Northeastern Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC, Harvard University), Applied Economics and Policy Seminar Series (Cornell University), KDI School

2021: Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA, online)

Journal Referee Service

Journal of Development Economics, Economics of Education Review, Economic Modeling, American Journal of Agricultural Economics, Education Economics, Food Policy, Journal of Development Studies, International Journal of Educational Development, Plos One

Other Service

Application Reviewer and Co-Mentor for STAARS Fellows Program, 2020–2021

Reviewer for Jobs and Development Conference 2024

Organizing Committee, KDI School - World Bank Development Impact Conference 2024–2026

OTHER EXPERIENCE

World Bank Group, Short-term Consultant, April 2022–June 2022

Project "Meta-analytic Reviews of Literature on Climate Change and Human Capital"

Asian Development Bank, Short-term Consultant, April 2021–March 2022

Project "Impact Evaluation for Skills Training and Education Pathways Upgradation"

Cornell University, RA for Professor Christopher B. Barrett, 2018–2020

KDI School of Public Policy and Management, RA for Professor Booyuel Kim, 2017–2018

VNU-Hanoi Institute for Economic and Policy Research, Researcher, 2016–2018

Project "Labor Productivity and Wage Growth in Vietnam"

Project "Development Characteristics of SME Sector in Vietnam: Evidence from the Vietnam Enterprise Census 2006-2015"

MISCELLANEOUS

Languages: Vietnamese (native), English (fluent), Korean (intermediate)